

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Safeer Butt

Address: 12 Golf Side Cheam Sutton SM2 7EZ

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment:Re: Planning Application DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station, Dorset Road, Belmont, SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Place of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub)

I write in strong support of this application.

This proposal represents a positive and inclusive development that would provide significant social and community benefits to the local area.

1. Community Integration & Demographics

The proposed use as a Place of Worship and Community Hub aligns well with the local demographic profile and the evolving needs of the area. Belmont and the surrounding neighbourhoods are home to a diverse and growing community. A facility such as this promotes:

Social cohesion

Inter-faith and intercultural dialogue

Community engagement across generations

A shared community space strengthens integration rather than division and provides a welcoming

focal point for residents of all backgrounds.

2. Walking Distance & Sustainable Location

The site is located within walking distance of residential areas, reducing reliance on vehicles. Many attendees are likely to walk, particularly:

Elderly residents

Families with children

Local residents living nearby

This supports sustainable transport objectives and minimises traffic impact.

3. Benefits for Elderly Residents

For older members of the community, especially those who may be socially isolated, having a local focal point is extremely valuable. The proposal offers:

A safe and accessible meeting space

Daytime activities and community gatherings

Opportunities for volunteering and social participation

Such facilities are proven to improve wellbeing and reduce isolation.

4. Youth Programs & Educational Classes

The inclusion of F2 Community Hub use will enable:

Youth engagement programmes

Children's educational classes

After-school and weekend activities

Cultural and language education

Community workshops and support sessions

These services benefit the whole community, not only worshippers.

5. Proven Local Precedent - No Parking or Traffic Issues

Nearby church facilities have operated for many years without material parking or traffic problems affecting neighbouring schools or residents. This demonstrates that:

The area can successfully accommodate similar uses

Concerns about excessive traffic are not supported by local experience

Importantly, the site's former use as an Ambulance Station generated operational traffic at all hours, including unsociable times (night and early morning). The proposed use would:

Be limited to specific hours

Generate significantly less vehicle movement

Eliminate emergency response traffic

This represents an improvement in amenity for neighbours.

6. Comparable Facilities Nearby

There are existing community and faith-based facilities operating in the wider area without adverse impact. This proposal is therefore consistent with the established character of community provision locally.

7. Responsible Management & Willingness to Engage

It is particularly reassuring that the management has expressed willingness to:

Engage proactively with neighbours

Implement practical measures to mitigate concerns

Manage parking responsibly

Coordinate major events sensitively

This collaborative approach demonstrates responsible stewardship.

Conclusion

This application represents:

A beneficial reuse of an existing building

Reduced unsociable traffic compared to its former use

A valuable asset for community integration

Support for elderly residents and young people

A sustainable, walkable local facility

For these reasons, I strongly support Planning Application DM2025/01591 and respectfully encourage the Council to approve it.